

Assemble Flat-Pack Furniture

A Survival Guide for Solo DIYers

Checklist for Success

1. The Pre-Assembly Ritual
2. Deciphering the Hieroglyphics
3. Assembly Pro-Tips
4. Solo Lifting Strategies
5. Fixing Common Mistakes

1. The Pre-Assembly Ritual

Never start building the second you open the box. Preparation is everything.

Hardware Inventory: Use a muffin tin to sort every screw, cam, and dowel. Match them to the list in the manual before you begin.



Missing a piece? Most IKEA stores have a "spare parts" wall near Customer Service where you can grab screws for free!

2. Deciphering the Hieroglyphics

Manuals have no words, so you must look at the **holes**. Every dot on the page represents a hole in the board. If yours don't match, you've got the board backward.

The "Finished Edge" Rule: Always identify the side with the wood grain. This side usually faces the front.

3. Assembly Pro-Tips

- **Wood Glue:** Put a drop in dowel holes for a rock-solid build.
- **Rubber Mallet:** Tap pieces together without leaving dents.
- **The "Hand Tight" Rule:** Stop turning as soon as the screw is flush. Particle board strips easily!

4. Solo Strategies

Working alone? Use the shipping boxes as props to hold up long boards while you screw them in. To move heavy items, place an old blanket under the legs and slide them across the floor.

5. Fixing Mistakes

Stripped a screw hole? Stuff a toothpick and some wood glue into the hole, let it dry, then drive the screw back in. It works every time.